ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Campus Safety and Scam Awareness: Protect Your Money and Yourself

Practical habits against fraud, theft and unsafe situations on and around campus

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Students lose money to fake agents, fake accommodation, fake scholarship portals and social-engineering calls. This pack covers how common scams work, how to verify before paying, safe meet-up habits and what to do after an incident.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Recognise common student-targeted scams and the pressure tactics they use.
- Verify a person, offer or portal before sending money.
- Apply personal-safety habits for late travel and meet-ups.
- Report incidents correctly and preserve evidence.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

How scams work

Fraud relies on urgency, authority and isolation. Break any one and the scam usually fails.

- Fake accommodation agents demand a deposit before inspection.
- Fake scholarship or job portals charge an application or processing fee.
- Impersonation calls claim to be from the bursary, your bank or a lecturer.
- Fake buyers overpay and ask for a refund of the difference.
- Investment schemes promise unrealistic daily returns and pay early members with later members' money.
- Pressure to act immediately and secretly is the strongest warning sign.

> **The pause rule**
> No legitimate transaction collapses because you took ten minutes to verify. If someone insists you cannot check, do not pay.

Verify before you pay

Verification is a process, not a feeling about the person.

1. Confirm identity through an independent channel you found yourself.
2. Verify ownership or authority with the institution, landlord or employer.
3. Never pay into a personal account for an institutional fee.
4. Ask for a written receipt and keep records of the conversation.
5. Check the official website or portal rather than a link sent to you.
6. For goods, inspect before paying; for services, agree milestones.

Personal safety and reporting

Most risk is managed by routine rather than by fear.

- Share your movement with a trusted friend when travelling late.
- Use well-lit, populated routes and registered transport.
- Meet buyers or sellers in public, busy locations during daylight.
- Keep bank alerts on and never share your PIN or OTP with anyone.
- Avoid displaying expensive items unnecessarily.
- After an incident, report to campus security and the police, and preserve messages and receipts.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Name three pressure tactics used by scammers.

Answer: Urgency, claimed authority and secrecy or isolation from people who could verify the offer.

2. Why is paying a deposit before inspecting accommodation risky?

Answer: The property may not exist or the person may not be authorised to collect rent, and recovery is difficult.

3. How should you verify a scholarship offer?

Answer: Check the official university or sponsor website and contact the institution through independently sourced contact details.

4. What should you do if you receive a suspicious call claiming to be your bank?

Answer: Hang up and call the bank's official number yourself. Never share PINs, OTPs or card details.

5. What evidence should you preserve after a scam?

Answer: Chats, call logs, account details, receipts and transaction references, along with a written timeline.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Save official university, bank and security numbers in your phone.
- [ ] Agree a late-travel check-in routine with a friend.
- [ ] Review your bank alert settings.
- [ ] Practise verifying one offer before paying.
- [ ] Learn where campus security is located.
- [ ] Write down the reporting steps for fraud.
- [ ] Talk through one scam example with a coursemate.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

> **More from the ZikShare Academic Vault**
> Find faculty primers, study-skills guides, money and career packs, and digital-skills workbooks in the ZikShare Library. New packs are added every semester.

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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